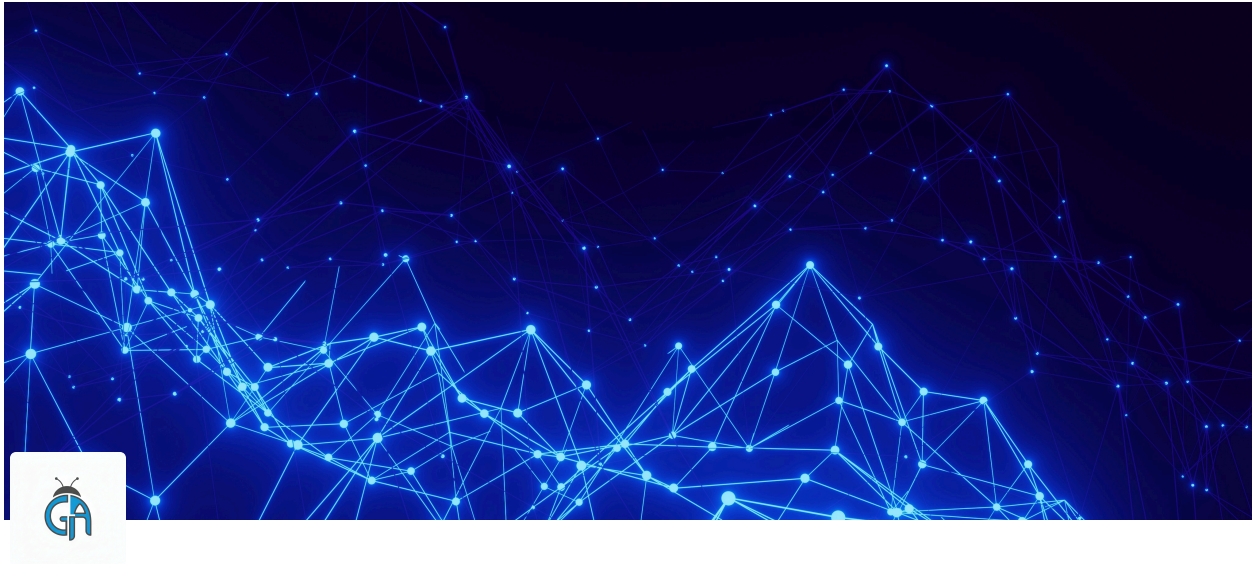




The QA Mythbuster Series: Episode 3

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 **Tags:** QA

 **Reading Time:** 4 min

 **TL;DR**

QA is not a scapegoat. We assess risk, report truth, and protect users.

Here are **5 more myths** about where QA's responsibility actually begins and ends.

 **The Myths Debunked**

Myth #11: "QA is responsible for quality."

 **The Lie:** "If there's a bug in production, it's QA's fault."

✅ **The Truth:** QA is responsible for **testing** and **reporting** quality. The whole team owns quality. Developers write the code. Product defines requirements. DevOps deploys it. QA assesses risk and communicates it. We can recommend "Do not release," but if stakeholders release anyway, that's a business decision, not a QA failure.

Myth #12: "All bugs must be fixed before release."

❌ **The Lie:** "Zero bugs = ready to ship."

✅ **The Truth:** We ship with known bugs all the time. It's called **Risk Management**. If there's a typo in the footer vs. a crash on payment, we fix the crash and ship with the typo. Perfect is the enemy of done. QA's job is to make sure stakeholders **know** what bugs exist and the **risk** of shipping them.

Myth #13: "Testers don't need to understand the business."

❌ **The Lie:** "Just test what's in the ticket."

✅ **The Truth:** Understanding the business separates good testers from great ones. If I'm testing a healthcare app, I need to know HIPAA regulations. If I'm testing e-commerce, I need to understand checkout psychology. Context changes **what** you test and **how hard** you test it. A delay in loading a game character? Low priority. A delay in loading a patient's medical record? Critical.

Myth #14: "Regression testing is just running old tests again."

❌ **The Lie:** "Copy-paste last sprint's test cases and re-run them."

✅ **The Truth:** Regression isn't mindless repetition. You must **update** tests based on new features, retire tests for deprecated features, and add tests for bugs we missed last time (**Pesticide Paradox**). Blindly running old tests wastes time and misses new risks.

Myth #15: "If automation coverage is 80%, we're safe."

❌ **The Lie:** "High code coverage = high quality."

✅ **The Truth:** Coverage measures **what was executed**, not **what was verified**. You can have 80% coverage but test nothing meaningful. Example: Your script opens 80% of the pages but never checks if the data is correct. Automation gives confidence, but only if the assertions are smart. Numbers lie; context matters.

💡 **Real World Example: Myth #12 - "All Bugs Must Be Fixed"**

Scenario: We're launching a mobile game update on Friday.

The Bugs I Found:

1. **Critical:** Game crashes when player reaches Level 10.
2. **Low:** The "Settings" icon is slightly misaligned on tablets.

The Decision:

- **QA:** "I recommend we delay the release to fix the crash. The misalignment can ship."
- **Product Manager:** "We promised players new content on Friday. Can we disable Level 10 temporarily?"
- **QA:** "Yes. I'll add a workaround test: Verify Level 9 is the max until the patch."

The Result:

We shipped on time with a known limitation (no Level 10). Players were happy. We fixed the crash in a patch 3 days later.

Perfect would have meant missing the deadline. Good was enough.
